



2026 AZERBAIJAN GRAND PRIX

24 - 26 September 2026

From	The Stewards	Document	49
To	The Team Manager, Atlassian Williams F1 Team	Date	25 September 2026
		Time	19:07

The Stewards, having received a report from the Race Director, summoned (document 45) and heard from the driver and team representative, have considered the following matter and determine the following:

No / Driver 55 - Carlos Sainz

Competitor Atlassian Williams F1 Team

Time 17:03

Session Qualifying

Fact Failure to slow for yellow flags

Infringement Breach of Appendix H, Article 2.5.5 b) of the International Sporting Code

Decision Drop of 5 grid positions for the next Sprint/Race in which the driver participates. 2 penalty points (total of 4 for the 12 month period).

Reason Reason: The Stewards heard from the driver of Car 55 (Carlos Sainz), team representative and reviewed video, timing, telemetry, team radio and in-car video evidence.

Single Yellow Flags were displayed in Marshalling Sectors 4 and 5, in particular after Turn 2 and on the approach to Turn 3. The Yellow indications were clearly visible and SAI had also received a radio warning from the Team: "Yellow ahead, lift." SAI confirmed at the hearing that he was aware of the Yellow Flag situation.

SAI explained that he intended to demonstrate a reduction in speed across the Yellow area as a whole. He stated that he did not consider it necessary to reduce speed on the straight and instead intended to demonstrate his response when approaching and exiting Turn 3. He considered this to be a "global lift" covering the consecutive Yellow sectors. He further explained that the car which had originally caused the Yellow was no longer in the run-off area and that he expected the Yellow Flags to be withdrawn.

The Stewards did not accept this interpretation. Where consecutive marshalling sectors are subject to Yellow Flag conditions, a driver must demonstrate a significant reaction to reduce speed in each individual Yellow marshalling sector. A reduction in a subsequent sector cannot retrospectively satisfy the requirement applicable to the preceding Yellow sector. The obligation is also not dependent on the driver's own assessment of whether the original hazard remains present within a particular part of the Yellow sector.

The telemetry clearly showed that SAI's reaction to the Yellow occurred only in Marshalling Sector 5. There was no meaningful reduction in speed in Marshalling Sector 4 which could realistically be attributed to a response to the Yellow.

Indeed, SAI recorded his fastest time of the session in Marshalling Sector 4.

The Stewards therefore did not accept that the subsequent lift in Marshalling Sector 5 constituted a sufficient “global” response covering both sectors. This is distinguishable from cases where the telemetry demonstrates a significant response to the Yellow even though the overall sector time reduction is relatively small.

In the present case, SAI was aware of the Yellow, had received an explicit warning from the Team, the Yellow indications were clearly visible and the telemetry established that he did not demonstrate the required reaction in Marshalling Sector 4.

The Stewards therefore determine that SAI failed to sufficiently reduce speed under the Single Yellow Flag in Marshalling Sector 4.

The standard penalty under the Penalty Guidelines for this infringement during Qualifying is a drop of 5 grid positions.

Competitors are reminded that they have the right to appeal certain decisions of the Stewards, in accordance with Article 15 of the FIA International Sporting Code and Chapter 5 of the FIA Judicial and Disciplinary Rules, within the applicable time limits.

Decisions of the Stewards are taken independently of the FIA and are based solely on the relevant regulations, guidelines and evidence presented.

Gerd Ennser

Loïc Bacquelaine

Khatuna Julakidze

Derek Warwick

Danil Solomin

The Stewards